

OpenClaw

OPEN SOURCE

AUTOMATION

“The personal AI agent that lives on your machine — reads your files, works your apps, and runs while you sleep.”

BEST FOR

- Targeted automation across your own files, apps, and messaging tools
- Connecting AI directly to WhatsApp, Discord, and local file systems
- Model-agnostic setups — bring your own API key or run a local model
- Repetitive, high-volume operational tasks run unattended
- Privacy-first automation that runs on your own Mac, Windows, or Linux machine

NOT BEST FOR

- ✗ Requires comfort installing and configuring local software
- ✗ No single official vendor — support is community-driven (Discord/GitHub)
- ✗ You're responsible for the underlying model's API costs

GETTING STARTED

- Install OpenClaw on Mac, Windows, or Linux from the official GitHub repo.
- Connect an API key from any supported provider — or run a fully local model.
- Enable AgentSkills for the tools you need (100+ preconfigured: shell, files, web).
- Connect WhatsApp, Discord, or your file system to start automating real tasks.

PRICING

PLAN	PRICE	NOTES
Software	Free (open-source)	Self-hosted, install from GitHub
Model/API cost	Varies by provider	Bring your own key (or run local, free)
Local-only setup	Free	No cloud API cost using local models via Ollama

KEY FEATURES

- Fully open-source and model-agnostic — swap providers at runtime without rebuilding
- 100+ preconfigured AgentSkills: shell commands, file management, web automation
- Supports Anthropic, OpenAI, Google, DeepSeek, Moonshot AI, and more, plus local models via Ollama
- Persistent memory across conversations and sessions
- Runs entirely on your own machine — nothing leaves it unless you route it out

PROMPT TEMPLATES

“Watch this folder and file every new invoice into the right client subfolder.”

“Every morning, check WhatsApp for unread client messages and draft replies for my review.”

“Scrape [site] daily and alert me in Discord when a new listing matches [criteria].”

“Rename and organize every file in this download folder by type and date.”

QUICK REFERENCE

First install	Clone the GitHub repo, follow the setup guide
Pick a brain	Add any provider's API key, or point it at a local model
Give it a job	Turn on the relevant AgentSkill(s)
Connect messaging	Link WhatsApp or Discord in settings
Run it unattended	Schedule the task, let it work in the background

PRO TIPS

- Start with a single, low-risk automation before connecting it to anything client-facing.
- Use a cheap/local model for routine automations and reserve a frontier model for judgment calls.
- Review exactly which AgentSkills are enabled — only turn on what a given automation needs.
- Because it's community-run, check the GitHub repo directly for the current release before installing.